

Yuehua Zhu 朱跃华

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PhD in multimodal vision and large-model applications with 4+ years at Ant Group, most recently as a Senior Algorithm Expert, shipping recommendation, RL-based marketing, and LLM post-training systems at billion-PV scale. I bridge CCF-A research with large-scale industrial deployment and AI-driven engineering productivity (Claude Code / Codex), with a track record of turning frontier methods into measurable business and social impact. I am eager to bring large-scale industry practice into the classroom and train students for real-world AI engineering.

EDUCATION

Xidian University — Ph.D., Electronic Science & Technology 2018.09 – 2023.06

Advisor: Prof. [Cheng Deng](#) (Changjiang Scholar Distinguished Professor). Focus: multimodal vision, large-model applications.

Xidian University — B.Eng., Electronic & Information Engineering 2014.09 – 2018.06

GPA Top 5%, admitted to a direct Ph.D. track.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

HKUST (Guangzhou) — Postdoctoral Researcher 2025.10 – 2026.06

- Leading R&D of an **LLM-driven global high-end talent-intelligence platform** for the Greater Bay Area (intelligent screening & credential verification), partnering with Guangzhou municipal organization and industry bureaus for precise talent matching.
- Co-developing a consumer **AI-agent earbud** integrating LLMs, semantic turn-taking, voiceprint recognition, and multi-platform tool calling — **awarded at the 51st International Exhibition of Inventions of Geneva, 2026**.

Ant Group — Senior Algorithm Expert, Content Platform Algorithm Team 2023.06 – 2025.08

- Led a cross-domain heterogeneous-data fusion recommendation system processing **2B+ daily PV** across 7 industries; delivered **+30% Asian Games ticketing distribution efficiency** (*Xinhua*) and **+17% GMV** for Alipay retail merchants (*36Kr*). Selected as a **UN ITU AI-for-Good best case** and a *China Top-10 AI Pioneer case*.
- Designed an **Actor-Critic reinforcement-learning content-marketing pricing framework**, modeling user revisit and dwell time as dynamic rewards: **+317% average dwell time** and **¥362M+ annual cost savings**; awarded Alipay's 2024 Best Technical Breakthrough.
- Built an **LLM data-augmentation training framework** (automatic synthesis + low-quality sample filtering) reused across business lines; **-60% annotation cost**, applied to post-training of **Ring** (Ant's first trillion-parameter LLM) and open-sourced on [HuggingFace](#).

Ant Group — Joint-Training Researcher, Recommendation Algorithm Team 2021.04 – 2023.04

- Proposed a **convolutional self-attention Transformer** for multimodal Feeds recommendation in Alipay wealth search and membership: **+2.6% core transaction PV**, **+1.32% click PV**. Published at [SIGIR](#); [national invention patent](#) granted.
- Led a Swin-based self-supervised framework with a multi-machine parallel strategy at the NeurIPS 2021 image-retrieval challenge, ranking **Top 1/100**; deployed for Alipay homepage image deduplication.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Progressive Self-Attention Network with Unsymmetrical Positional Encoding for Sequential Recommendation*. **SIGIR 2022 (CCF-A)** — first author. · [\[code\]](#)
- Divide and Conquer: Compositional Experts for Generalized Novel Class Discovery*. **CVPR 2022 (CCF-A)** — co-first author. · [\[code\]](#)
- Fewer is More: A Deep Graph Metric Learning Perspective Using Fewer Proxies*. **NeurIPS 2020 (CCF-A)** — first author, **Spotlight (~3%)**, 10-minute oral. · [\[code\]](#)
- Object and Background Disentanglement for Unsupervised Cross-domain Person Re-identification*. **Neurocomputing 2020 (JCR Q1)** — first author.

TEACHING & MENTORING

- Delivered a 10-minute oral presentation at NeurIPS (Spotlight, top ~3%); experienced presenting to international audiences.
- Led cross-functional software/hardware teams and mentored algorithm engineers at Ant Group and HKUST (Guangzhou).
- Industry-academia collaborations with Tencent AI Lab and the National Health Commission medical LLM program; open-source advocate on [HuggingFace](#).

HONORS & AWARDS

Alibaba & Ant "Ant Star" Senior Talent Program — **fewer than 10 selected globally per year** (2023) · Hangzhou High-Level Talent (2024) · 51st Geneva International Exhibition of Inventions Award (2026) · NeurIPS 2020 Spotlight (~3%) · National College Mathematics Competition Provincial First Prize, full marks · National Invention Patent (granted).